

Getting Around Calgary When You Cannot Use the Bus

Two real doors: Calgary Transit Access, and the AISH transportation benefit. A plain-language guide.

If you cannot stand or walk far enough to use a regular bus or CTrain, you have options, and you are allowed to use them. Here are two, and how they work together.

Door 1: Calgary Transit Access (CTA)

A shared-ride, door-to-door public transit service for people whose disability prevents them from using regular buses and CTrains. You stay seated the whole way. This is the service some people still call Access Calgary; the current name is Calgary Transit Access.

Who qualifies: eligibility is based on one thing only, whether you can physically or cognitively use a regular bus or CTrain. Not your age, not your income, not whether you can drive, not how long the trip is.

How to apply

- 1 **Get the form.** Call 403-537-7770 to have one mailed to you, or download it from calgarytransit.com.
- 2 **Fill out Sections A to F** yourself.
- 3 **Your doctor completes Section G**, the medical part. Before you pay any fee for that form, ask whether AISH will cover the cost.
- 4 **Submit it.** Email calgarytransitaccesseligibility@calgary.ca, or fax 403-537-7812.
- 5 **Go to a short eligibility interview.** They call to book it. Bring photo ID and proof of address.

Questions along the way: 403-537-7777, press 5.

One thing to know: applying does not guarantee approval, they assess each person. But not being able to use a regular bus safely is exactly what this service is for.

Door 2: The AISH transportation benefit (for private drives)

AISH has personal benefits, money on top of your monthly amount for specific needs, and transportation to medical appointments can be covered at the most economical cost.

When a friend or roommate drives you: ask your worker how they reimburse a private driver, meaning mileage or fuel. The person helping you should not have to do it for free.

Ask your worker, and get the answer in writing. A note from your doctor saying you cannot safely use public transit turns your request from a story into documented need.

How they fit together: Calgary Transit Access gets you to appointments in a vehicle where you stay seated. The AISH transportation benefit covers the private drives you still need, so no one has to be your unpaid chauffeur. Between the two, getting to a doctor should never hang on whether a friend is free that day.

Verified against Calgary Transit and Government of Alberta information, July 2026. Details can change, so confirm anything that affects you by phone.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

St. Albert, Alberta | July 2026 | albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com